

Fixing And Improving HTML Tables

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What We'll Learn

By the end of this lesson, students can:

- Identify common errors in HTML tables.
- Correct misplaced or missing table elements.
- Check whether each row contains the correct number of cells.
- Improve a table using headings, captions, colspan, and rowspan.

Before We Start

Imagine that you created a table, but its information appeared in the wrong columns.

What mistakes in the HTML code might cause this problem?

Let's Understand

An HTML table may not display correctly when its elements are missing, misplaced, or improperly arranged.

A properly structured table follows this order:

```
<table>
  <caption>Table Caption</caption>

  <tr>
    <th>Heading 1</th>
    <th>Heading 2</th>
  </tr>

  <tr>
    <td>Data 1</td>
    <td>Data 2</td>
  </tr>
</table>
```

Remember these important rules:

1. The `<caption>` must be placed inside the `<table>`.
2. Every table row must use `<tr>`.
3. Every `<th>` and `<td>` must be placed inside a `<tr>`.
4. Opening tags must have the correct closing tags.
5. Rows should normally contain the correct number of cells.
6. The values of `colspan` and `rowspan` must match the cells they cover.

Ways to Improve a Table

A table can be improved by:

- Adding a clear `<caption>`.
- Using `<th>` for column or row headings.
- Organizing related information into proper rows.
- Using `colspan` when a cell must cover multiple columns.
- Using `rowspan` when a cell must cover multiple rows.
- Removing unnecessary or repeated cells.

Let's Practice

Find and correct the errors in the following table:

```
<table>
  <caption>Class Officers</caption>

  <tr>
    <th>Name</th>
    <th>Position</th>
  </tr>

  <td>Maria</td>
  <td>President</td>

  <tr>
    <td>Joshua</td>
  </tr>
</table>
```

After correcting the code, the table should:

- Place every data cell inside a table row.
- Contain two cells in each student row.
- Show Joshua's position as Vice President.

Challenge Task

Fix and improve the following table:

```
<table>
  <caption>School Canteen Menu</caption>

  <tr>
    <th colspan="2">Available Meals</th>
  </tr>

  <tr>
    <th>Meal</th>
    <th>Price</th>
    <th>Availability</th>
  </tr>

  <td>Spaghetti</td>
  <td>P50</td>
  <td>Morning</td>

  <tr>
    <td>Sandwich</td>
    <td>P35</td>
  </tr>
</table>
```

Your corrected table must:

- Use the proper table structure.
- Keep all cells inside table rows.
- Contain three columns.
- Make Available Meals cover all three columns.
- Add Whole Day as the availability of the sandwich.
- Use the correct closing tags.
- Display all information under the correct headings.

Resources / References

- Text editor
- Web browser
- Previous lessons about HTML tables
- Previous lesson about colspan and rowspan